

Connecting to the Internet

You can use your browser immediately to surf the Internet if your connection doesn't need any sort of authentication. Such connections are common in offices, but for home users, ISPs set a username and password for your account. In most cases, the ISP provides its users a connection client capable of running on different operating systems; it facilitates connection and authentication to their server. Under such circumstances, demand a Linux version of the client from your ISP.

7.2.2 Dial-up Internet

Various distributions have scripted a Wizard to help you install a modem and also configure it to dial up to your ISP. Such Wizards will normally be available under the "System Tools" or a similar application group, depending on the distribution. We can set up a dial-up connection through the command line too, which is by and large common to all Linux distribution (unless they have deliberately excluded it), but this can get very tricky. The easiest option is to locate and use the Wizard. We shall consider KPPP, a KDE application to configure a dial-up connection. This application is also available under the GNOME desktop environment.

Some distributions such as SuSE allow any user to run the application, but Redhat demands authentication for using such applications. It is better to switch to root user or log in as root when setting up the network.

You need to understand that many internal PCI modems were designed specifically for the Windows operating system, and so were termed "win modems." Certain newer ones work perfectly with Linux systems, but this problem is still not sorted out. If you happen to possess a win modem, note down your modem details such as the model number and manufacturer. The details can be accessed by using the command `"lspci | grep -i modem"`.

The solution is dependant on your model of win modem. There are a lot of Web pages that can guide you towards overcoming the